

Project 2: Website Proposal

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1. Client and Topic

Reach San Pedro is a Christian church serving the San Pedro community and is the nonprofit organization for which this website is being developed. This project will propose a new, professional website for the organization that provides information about the church, its ministries, services, events, outreach efforts, and opportunities for visitors and members to connect and serve.

2. Development Process and Engagement

This website will be developed for Reach San Pedro as a client, so the church will be involved throughout the development process. Initial discussions will be used to identify the church's goals, content needs, target audiences, and desired functionality. Feedback from the church leadership and appropriate ministry team members will help guide the site's content, organization, and design. During development, the website will be reviewed periodically to identify needed changes, confirm that the information is accurate, and ensure that the finished site meets the needs of both the church and its visitors.

3. Testing

Prior to the website launch, I will test the site to ensure that it functions as intended and meets the requirements established with the client. Testing will include checking all navigation links, dropdown menus, forms, buttons, images, multimedia and other interactive elements to ensure they work as intended.

I will also test the website at different screen sizes to verify responsive behavior and usability on desktop, tablet, and mobile devices. The site will be tested using multiple browsers, including Safari, Firefox, Chrome and Edge. User testing will also be conducted with the selected church members and potential visitors to gather feedback on the organization, navigation, readability, accessibility, usability, and clarity of the content. Feedback will be considered from users with different levels of experience with technology and, when possible, from users who represent different age groups and accessibility needs.

Finally, I will also review the content for accuracy and consistency, as well as conduct a final review with the client to identify and correct any remaining issues before launch.

4. Description

Reach San Pedro is a Christian church serving the San Pedro community with the goal of providing a welcoming environment where people can worship, grow in their faith, develop meaningful relationships, and serve others. The purpose of the proposed website is to provide an accessible and informative online presence that introduces visitors to the church while providing current members with convenient access to church information and resources.

The primary audiences will include people who are considering visiting the church, current members and regular attendees, and members of the surrounding community. These audiences may include people of different ages, levels of technological experience, abilities, and language backgrounds. Visitors may access the website from a variety of devices while looking for information such as service times, directions, events, ministries, or ways to connect. These considerations will influence the website's organization, navigation, content, accessibility, and responsive design in ways that require an emphasis on clear, intuitive, and easy-to-use interactions.

The site will provide original content about Reach San Pedro, including descriptions of its ministries, serving opportunities, outreach activities, events, beliefs, leadership, and other church resources. Original photographs and other media will also be

incorporated when available. Information from outside sources may be used when appropriate, including embedded sermon videos or other video content, maps, social media, and third-party services such as online giving. Any externally sourced content will be used appropriately and credited when required. Website content will need to be reviewed and updated regularly, particularly the event information, sermons, ministry information, and other time-sensitive content so that visitors and members can rely on the website for accurate information.

5. Growth and Maintenance

The Reach San Pedro website should continue to grow as the church develops new ministries, programs, outreach opportunities, events, and digital resources. The website will be designed with a consistent structure and reusable styles so that the new content can be added without requiring major changes to the overall design. Organizing content into clearly defined pages and maintaining a consistent file and naming structure will also make the site easier to manage. Regular maintenance will include updating events and time-sensitive information weekly or as needed, adding new sermons weekly as they become available, reviewing ministry information monthly or as changes occur, checking links and forms monthly, and reviewing the website for accessibility and usability issues monthly. Announcements and other frequently changing content may also require weekly updates. Security, software, scripts, and third-party services should also be reviewed monthly and whenever updates or security advisories are released to ensure that they remain current and functional. Lastly, though services are currently only offered in English, Reach San Pedro also serves a significant Spanish-speaking population, so language accessibility should be considered as the website develops, with the potential for Spanish-language content or translation services to be added in the future.

6. Organization

The Reach San Pedro website will use a clear hierarchical structure to organize information according to the needs of visitors, members, and the surrounding community. There are 11 pages in total, and the primary navigation will include the following pages:

- **Home**
- **About**

- **Connect**
- **Sermons**
- **Events**
- **Give**
- **Contact**

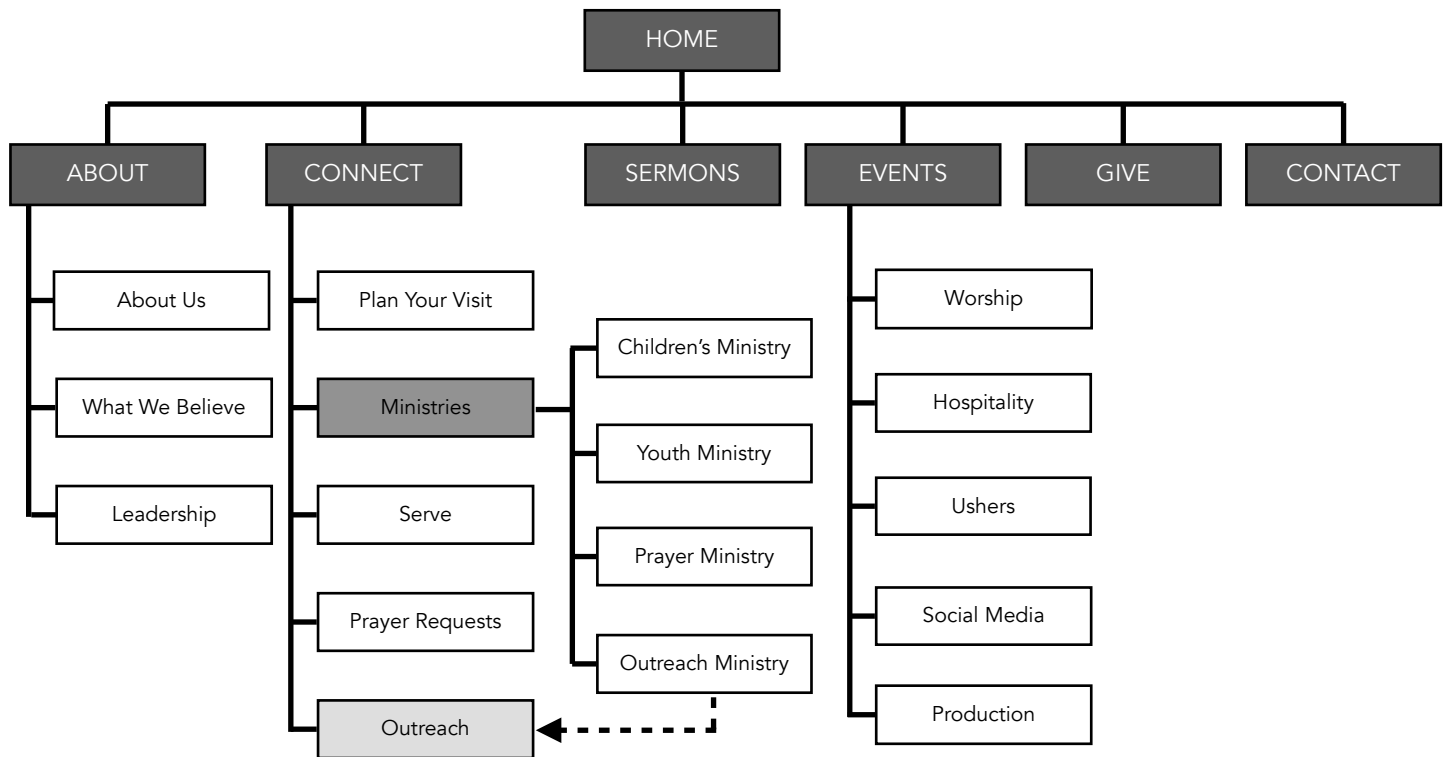
Home will serve as the website's landing page and will also be accessible through the site logo and navigation.

The About page will contain sections for About Us, What We Believe, and Leadership. The Connect page will provide information and links to opportunities for visitors and members to connect with the church, including Plan Your Visit, Ministries, Serve, Prayer Requests, and Outreach. Outreach will also be accessible through the Ministries page because it is both an important area of the church's community involvement and a ministry in which members can participate. The dedicated Outreach page will focus on the church's outreach initiatives and opportunities to engage with and serve the surrounding community.

The Ministries section will organize information about Children's, Youth, Prayer, and Outreach ministries, while the Serve page will provide information about Worship, Hospitality, Ushers, Social Media, and Production.

The website will use consistent layouts, typography, navigation, and visual elements throughout the site. The design will be responsive so that the content remains accessible and usable across desktop, tablet, and mobile devices. Navigation will use dropdown menus where appropriate while keeping the primary navigation concise and easy to understand. The visual sitemap will illustrate the relationships between pages, while wireframes for the home page and an interior page will establish the proposed layout before development begins.

SITE MAP



- Main Navigation Page
- Subpage/Section
- Section Page (with subpages)
- Dedicated Page (linked from multiple areas)
- - - Also accessible through this path

WIRE FRAME 1: HOME PAGE

Logo

HOMEABOUTCONNECTSERMONSEVENTSGIVECONTACT

WELCOME TO
REACH SAN PEDRO

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PLAN YOUR VISIT

SERVICE TIMES

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LOCATION

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WELCOME ALL

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ABOUT REACH SAN PEDRO

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LEARN MORE

UPCOMING EVENTS

TITLE

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TITLE

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VIEW ALL EVENTS

FEATURED SERMON

SERMON TITLE
DATE

WATCH SERMON

GET CONNECTED

SERVE

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EXPLORE

MINISTRIES

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GET INVOLVED

PRAYER REQUESTS

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SUBMIT REQUEST

GIVE

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GIVE ONLINE

REACH
SAN PEDRO

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QUICK LINKS

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CONTACT

✉ email@email.com
☎ (123) 456-7890
✉ 123 S. Anywhere
San Pedro, CA

FOLLOW US

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STAY CONNECTED

Lorem ipsum dolor sit
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Email

Subscribe

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WIRE FRAME 2: PLAN YOUR VISIT (INTERIOR PAGE)

Reach San Pedro

 LOGO

HOMEABOUTCONNECTSERMONSEVENTSGIVECONTACT

PLAN YOUR VISIT

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SERVICE TIMES

Sunday Worship Services
10:00 AM

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LOCATION

123 S. Anywhere
San Pedro, CA

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LOCATION MAP



GET DIRECTIONS

WHAT TO EXPECT



WELCOMING
ENVIRONMENT

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PRAISE AND
WORSHIP

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BIBLICAL
TEACHING

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CONNECTION
BUILDING

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FAMILIES AND CHILDREN

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WHAT TO WEAR

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PARKING

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REACH
SAN PEDRO

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QUICK LINKS

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CONTACT

 email@email.com
 (123) 456-7890
 123 S. Anywhere
San Pedro, CA

FOLLOW US



STAY CONNECTED

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Email

Subscribe

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7. Security

The Reach San Pedro website will include an online giving component, but the payment processing will be handled through the church's existing Planning Center/ Church Center service rather than storing payment information directly on the website. Security will be an important consideration when developing the website, particularly because it will include forms that collect personal information. The public website will not contain password-protected content because it is intended to provide publicly accessible information to visitors and members. Users will not be required to create accounts to access the website. Any account-based or member-specific functions can be handled through the existing Church Center service. The Prayer Request and Contact forms will collect only the information necessary for their intended purposes and will be handled securely. The website will use HTTPS/SSL to protect information transmitted between visitors and the site. Administrative accounts and hosting services will be protected through strong passwords and appropriate access controls. Third-party scripts, services, and software will be obtained from reputable sources and kept updated to reduce security risks. Regular maintenance and security reviews will also be performed to identify and address potential vulnerabilities.

8. Web Hosting

The proposed primary domain for the Reach San Pedro website is reachsanpedro.org. Because Reach San Pedro is a Christian church serving the local community, the .org extension appropriately represents the organization's nonprofit and community-focused nature. The domain is also already registered for the proposed website. The corresponding reachsanpedro.com domain is also registered and would be retained and configured to permanently redirect visitors to the primary .org domain.

When selecting a web host for Reach San Pedro, important considerations will include affordability, reliability, security, performance, available storage and bandwidth, technical support, SSL/HTTPS, backup capabilities, and ease of maintenance. Because Reach San Pedro is a nonprofit organization without paid dedicated technical staff, hosting services and other website solutions must be highly affordable and require minimal ongoing technical maintenance. The selected hosting provider should offer the necessary features without introducing unnecessary complexity or requiring specialized technical expertise for routine maintenance. The hosting solution should also provide flexibility for future growth and support third-party services such as online giving, embedded video, maps, and forms.

Potential hosting providers, including Hostinger, will be evaluated according to these criteria before a final selection is made. Hostinger is currently a potential option because the website can be developed using HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript, and Hostinger provides hosting features such as SSL, backups, security tools, and support for code-based websites. The existing Planning Center and Church Center services will also be incorporated into the website where appropriate. Rather than duplicating functions already provided by the church's existing services, the website can link to or integrate with Church Center for features such as online giving, forms, and events. This approach can reduce development and maintenance requirements while allowing the church to continue using systems with which it is already familiar.

The website will primarily require HTML5 for structure, CSS3 for presentation and responsive design, and JavaScript for interactive functionality. Third-party services can be used when appropriate rather than requiring the website to directly process sensitive information such as payment information for online giving.

9. Marketing

The Reach San Pedro website will be promoted through the church's existing social media presence, including Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube, as well as through the church announcements, printed materials, community outreach activities, and the existing Church Center app. The website URL can be included in social media profiles, email communications, printed materials, and other church communications to encourage visitors to access the site. The website and Church Center can work together by directing visitors to appropriate Church Center resources for events, forms, online giving, and other church services. Planning Center allows Church Center pages and features such as the main calendar, forms, and giving to be linked to or, where appropriate, embedded in an external church website.

Search engine optimization will be incorporated through descriptive page titles, relevant meta descriptions, appropriate keywords, descriptive headings, meaningful link text, accessible image alt text, and useful, original content. The site will also use a clear navigation structure and responsive design to improve the user experience across devices. Keeping content current and relevant will help the website remain useful to visitors and improve its potential visibility in search results.

10. Project Reflection

Overall, I appreciated completing this project because it forced me to slow down and think through the website as a whole before trying to jump into the design and development process. Creating the project plan, sitemap, and wireframes made me consider the overall flow of the website while taking into account the information both visitors and church members would need. I also had to consider the core functionality that would be useful to the organization of the website. This process helped me understand how important planning is to creating a website that is organized, purposeful, and usable rather than simply visually appealing.

One of the most valuable parts of this project has been the opportunity to work with an actual client. Speaking with the church leadership helped me better understand what Reach San Pedro is actually looking for in a website and allowed me to help refine some of their needs throughout the planning process. The church is primarily looking for an affordable and easily managed solution that their admin staff can add events to and direct visitors to the site's weekly YouTube content. Because the church already uses Planning Center and the Church Center app, they dedicate a portion of their limited budget to some of the services that will help keep the website simple to manage and more affordable to host. Incorporating these existing resources is an outside-the-box solution that they had not previously considered.

Working with a real organization also required me to think beyond the immediate requirements of the project. In particular, I considered the church's Spanish-speakers and the possibility of adding Spanish language content or translation services as the church grows, which is something the church has been struggling to integrate in the past since they do not have a dedicated Spanish service but would like to still reach that particular demographic of the community. I also had to consider that the church does not have dedicated technical staff with enough technical expertise. This reinforced the importance of selecting solutions that are affordable, reliable, accessible, and simple enough for them to maintain over time.

This project also gave me a better appreciation for the role of a web designer as more than someone who creates the visual appearance of a website. A designer must understand the client's goals, audiences, resources, technical limitations, and future needs before making design decisions. Overall, this project helped me develop a more thoughtful approach to website planning and gave me valuable experience working through the needs of a real client. I believe that the planning completed in this project will provide a much stronger foundation for the actual design and development of the Reach San Pedro website.